

MODULE 2

AI-POWERED PERSONAL BRANDING AND LINKEDIN OPTIMISATION

Goal

Enable participants to build a strong, authentic professional identity and create an optimised LinkedIn profile using AI. Share examples of diverse AI tools can be utilized.



Chapter 1

What Human Resources Sees in the First 30 Seconds Start Here

Imagine a recruiter has a search results page open, a vacancy to fill, and dozens of similar candidates. They do not begin by reading every sentence. They first ask: Is this person relevant enough to inspect further? Your LinkedIn profile must answer that question quickly and truthfully.

Citing an [Interviewpal study](#), recruiters spend 11 seconds on a resume in the AI age. Other studies from [Ladders](#) even say it's only 7.4 seconds. This makes creating a short and impactful resume more important than ever. AI can help you to write high-quality resumes quickly and grounded by your actual experience for HR to screen.

30-Second Goal

Make the recruiter understand your target role, evidence of readiness, location or availability, and next action before they need to scroll deeply.



What the First Scan Usually Checks

- **Name, photo, and banner:** Do you look like a real professional person with a usable profile, not an abandoned account?
- **Headline:** Can HR immediately see your role direction, strongest skill area, and audience or industry?
- **Location and availability:** Are you searchable for the market where the role is located, including remote or relocation preferences?
- **Current role, education, or project anchor:** Is there a credible reason to consider you for the target role?
- **About opening lines:** Do the first lines show focus and substance, or do they start with vague passion statements?
- **Skills and keywords:** Are target-role skills listed in the Skills section and repeated naturally in About and Experience?
- **Experience evidence:** Do entries show actions, tools, outputs, and impact rather than task-only descriptions?
- **Activity and proof:** Is there any post, Featured item, portfolio, certificate, project, or recommendation that supports the profile?
- **Consistency:** Do the headline, About, Experience, CV, and target job direction tell the same story?
- **Risk signals:** Are there exaggerations, irrelevant memes, confusing job titles, missing dates, or claims that sound generated?

Why These Elements Matter in Recruiter Search

LinkedIn states that completing recommended profile sections improves discoverability and search appearances; the recommended sections include profile photo, location, industry, education, position, skills, and summary. LinkedIn Recruiter search filters also use profile data such as schools, seniority, skills, spoken languages, location, and candidate activity. This does not mean a complete profile guarantees interviews. It means missing or vague sections can make it harder for you to find and harder to understand.

The practical lesson for beginners: HR does not only read your About section. They search, filter, skim, compare, and shortlist. A good profile is therefore both human-readable and search-readable.

The 3-Element First-Scan Checklist



Profile Example: [Irvandias Sanjaya](#)

Element	Headline
HR reads for	Role + value + evidence or skill + audience/industry.
Fix if weak	Rewrite with Careerflow, Jobscan, or LinkedIn Premium suggestions.



About

Irvandias Sanjaya (Dias) is a career development enthusiast with 8 years of cross-industry experience. He is an ICF-Aligned Coaching Indonesia Certification Coach and a BNSP-Level 6 Certified Master Trainer, with a strong track record in career coaching, talent development, and public speaking.

Dias has accumulated over 400 hours of coaching experience, supporting more than 500 job seekers in securing employment. He previously served as a Career Coach at Rumah Slap Kerja and is currently contributing as a Career Coach at Revolu, as well as an Expert at IKIGAI Consulting and Relasi Diri. Earlier in his career, he worked as a Partnership Manager at Artemis Impact, focusing on building collaborations within the social impact ecosystem.

Since 2016, Dias has been an active national public speaker and trainer, delivering over 700 hours of sessions and reaching more than 70,000 participants. He has collaborated with 75+ organizations, including Apple Developer Academy, Gojek, Nutrifood, AIESEC, Pertamina, Telkomsel, and Google Kormo. His areas of expertise include career development, personal branding, public speaking, leadership, social entrepreneurship, and inclusivity.

During his university years, Dias co-founded DesignforDream.id, a platform focused on economic inclusion for persons with disabilities. He also leads Yayasan Disabilitas Berkarya Setara, advancing inclusive education initiatives in Indonesia, including the "Overheard Difabel" podcast on Spotify. Additionally, he co-hosts the "Ganteng-Ganteng Manchester United (GGMU) Podcast," part of Kukila Network.

Dias is also a published author, contributing to several collaborative books such as Gen Resilience, Abroad Youth Vol. 1, Aku Juga Anak Indonesia, Dari Senggigi untuk Indonesia, and 23 Extra Miles.

His achievements include being the 1st Winner of the Busan Global Smart Cities Challenge (2017), Best Project Presentation by the Youth Time Organization (Czech Republic, 2016), and Winner of Habitat for Humanity's House Young Advocacy Grants (2016). He was also recognized as a LinkedIn Power Profile in Social Impact (2016).

Dias holds a psychology degree from Universitas Gadjah Mada, where he was awarded the 1st Most Outstanding Student of the Faculty of Psychology (2017). He is also an alumnus of Young Leaders for Indonesia (McKinsey) and a YSEALI Academic Fellow at Arizona State University.

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 Lynk/irvandiasanjaya



Top skills

Public Speaking • Career Counseling • Coaching & Mentoring • Podcasting • Project Management



Good About Section Example: [Irvandias Sanjaya](#)

Element

About section

HR reads for

First 2-3 lines state direction, strengths, and proof.

Fix if weak

Use the three-sentence structure in Chapter 2.

Element

Consistency

HR reads for

CV, headline, About, and target roles tell the same story.

Fix if weak

Compare with Teal, Kickresume, or Rezi outputs.

What Not to Do

- Do not copy another person's headline or About section. The same words will not carry the same evidence.
- Do not fill the headline with Open to Work only. Use role and skill keywords; use LinkedIn job preferences for availability.
- Do not claim expert status if you are a beginner. Use phrases such as aspiring, junior, student, intern, or entry-level with concrete proof.
- Do not let an AI tool turn your profile into a generic, over-polished paragraph that no longer sounds like you.



Chapter 2

HEADLINE FORMULA AND ABOUT STRUCTURE WITH AI SUPPORT

KEY IDEAS

A strong LinkedIn headline is not a slogan. It is a searchable positioning line. A strong About section is not an autobiography. It is a short case for why your skills, story, and target direction make sense.

Headline Formula

Beginner Formula

[Target role or identity] + [2-3 role keywords or strengths] + [audience, industry, or proof context]

This formula is flexible. Beginners can choose honest words that match their current stage. A student does not need to pretend to be a senior professional. A career switcher does not need to hide previous experience; they need to translate it into the new field.

Headline		Why
Clarity		
Before	Fresh Graduate Hardworking Open to Work	This is too vague. It does not say target role, field, tools, or value.
After	Junior Data Analyst Excel, SQL & Power BI Turning operations data into clear dashboards	Shows role, tools, and output.
Specific		
Before	Marketing Enthusiast Creative Fast Learner	The words are too broad. Common words: weak search value.

After	Entry-Level Digital Marketer Content Planning, Canva & Meta Ads Helping SMEs improve campaign clarity	Shows direction, tools, and audience.
Honesty		
Before	HR Expert and Strategic Talent Leader	The headline sounds very senior. Risky if the evidence is early-career.
After	HR Assistant Candidate Recruitment Coordination, Interview Scheduling & HRIS Basics Psychology Graduate	Honest and searchable.

About Section Structure

Three-Sentence Beginner Structure

Sentence 1: Who I am and what direction I am building toward.

Sentence 2: What evidence, skills, tools, or experiences support that direction?

Sentence 3: What I am looking for and how I want to contribute.

After the three-sentence opening, you can add 3-5 short bullets. The opening is for quick clarity. The bullets are for evidence and keywords. This prevents the About section from becoming a long emotional essay or a keyword list with no human story.

Fresh graduate

I am an economics graduate building toward entry-level data and business analyst roles. Through coursework and projects, I have used Excel, SQL basics, survey analysis, and dashboard storytelling to turn messy information into clearer decisions. I am looking for analyst, operations, or research roles where I can support teams with careful analysis and practical reporting.

Student/intern

I am a final-year communications student interested in digital marketing and brand storytelling for social-impact organizations. I have built campaign plans, edited short-form content, managed class project pages, and used Canva, CapCut, and Meta Business Suite for my projects. I am seeking internship opportunities where I can help teams create useful, audience-aware content while continuing to learn from feedback.

Specialised Tool Workflow

Use tools in a sequence, not randomly. Start with profile structure, then keyword fit, then writing quality, then consistency with CV and target roles, then ongoing visibility.

Step	Step 1
Purpose	Profile structure scan
Example tools	Careerflow or LinkedIn profile meter
Output	Find missing sections and visible weaknesses.

Step	Step 2
Purpose	Keyword alignment
Example tools	Jobscan , Teal , SkillSyncer , Rezi
Output	Compare the profile/CV language against 3 target job descriptions.

Step	Step 3
Purpose	LinkedIn wording review
Example tools	Resume Worded , LinkedIn Review , Careerflow , Jobscan
Output	Improve the headline, About, and experience phrasing.

Tool Guide 1: [Careerflow LinkedIn Optimizer](#)



Best for beginners who need a guided checklist. Careerflow describes its LinkedIn Optimizer as a free tool that gives actionable tips, personalized checklists, and a real-time walkthrough. It covers visible sections such as headline, photo, banner, URL, skills, and work history, and can analyze profiles in multiple languages.

1. Create or open a Careerflow account and install the LinkedIn Optimizer or open the web tool.
2. Open your LinkedIn profile in the same browser and run the profile scan.
3. Record your starting score and the lowest-scoring sections.
4. Fix profile basics first: photo, banner, headline, location, current education or role, and skills.
5. Use Careerflow suggestions for wording, but edit the final copy so it matches your real evidence and target role.
6. Run the score again and record the before/after result.

Tool Guide 2: [Jobscan LinkedIn Optimization](#)



Best when you have a target role. Jobscan asks users to paste a LinkedIn profile URL and add at least three job descriptions. It then gives a profile score, keyword suggestions, headline recommendations, and summary help. This is useful because LinkedIn optimization should not be generic; a data analyst, HR assistant, and content marketer need different keywords.

1. Find three real job descriptions for the same target direction, preferably from ASEAN markets or remote roles you would actually apply to.
2. Paste your LinkedIn profile URL into Jobscan.
3. Paste the three job descriptions and run the scan.
4. List the missing or weak keywords that are honestly true for you.
5. Add only skills you can defend with an example. Do not add tools you have never used.
6. Use the headline and summary recommendations as options, then rewrite in your own voice before copying to LinkedIn.

Best input if the tool asks for instructions

Target role: [role]. Target market: [country/city/remote]. Evidence I can prove: [projects, coursework, internships, tools]. Do not add skills, achievements, certifications, or metrics that are not in my evidence list.

Complete example prompt

Act as a LinkedIn profile editor for an early-career candidate.

Context: I am an economics graduate in Jakarta targeting junior data analyst and operations analyst roles. I have completed a university survey project and an operations dashboard project. I have used Excel, Power BI, and basic SQL. I do not have full-time analyst experience yet.

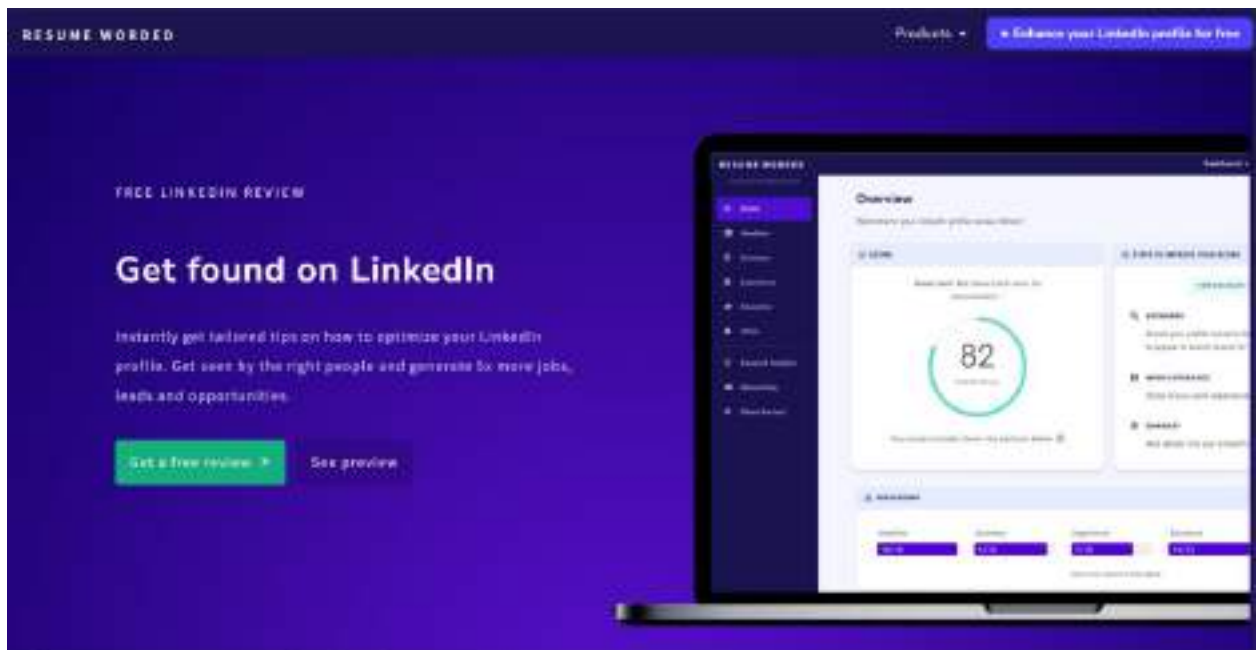
Objective: Draft three LinkedIn headline options and one About section that make my direction, evidence, and contribution clear to recruiters.

Constraints: Use only the evidence above. Do not invent employers, metrics, certifications, achievements, or advanced skills. Keep the tone confident, specific, modest, and natural. Avoid generic claims such as 'hardworking' or 'results-driven.'

Desired output:

1. Three headlines, each under LinkedIn's current character limit.
2. One About section with a three-sentence opening and 3-5 evidence bullets.
3. A short explanation of the keywords used and where each claim came from.
4. A final fact-check list showing anything I must verify before publishing.

Tool Guide 3: [Resume Worded LinkedIn Review](#)



Best for a written feedback report. Resume Worded's help center says LinkedIn Review uses a downloaded LinkedIn profile PDF. Its scoring is based on checks run on the profile and is weighted by importance rather than a simple average. This can help you see whether their profile has a weak impact, weak wording, or missing sections.

1. Open LinkedIn on desktop, go to your profile, click More, and choose Save to PDF.
2. Upload the profile PDF to the Resume Worded LinkedIn Review.
3. Read the score by section. Do not chase a number blindly; identify the top 3 changes that are true and useful.
4. Revise the headline, About, and experience bullets based on the report.
5. Export a new LinkedIn PDF after editing and re-run the review if your access allows it.
6. Save the report notes in your learning folder for before/after reflection.

Chapter 3

UPDATE YOUR HEADLINE AND ABOUT SECTION

APPLY IT

This chapter turns the lesson into a real LinkedIn update. The safest workflow is slow enough to prevent exaggeration and fast enough to finish in one practice session.

Before You Edit: Build Your Evidence Bank

Write only what you can defend. A beginner profile can still be strong if it is specific. Use the evidence bank below before opening any tool.

Field	Example of your answer
Target role direction	Example: junior data analyst, HR assistant, social media intern, project coordinator, software intern.
Target industry or audience	Example: education, logistics, fintech, social impact, SMEs, hospitality, public sector.
Tools I have actually used	Example: Excel, Power BI, Canva, CapCut, SQL basics, Google Workspace, HRIS basics, Figma, GitHub.
Proof projects	Example: dashboard, campaign plan, survey report, portfolio site, class research, internship output, volunteer event.
People or problems I help	Example: students understand information, teams track data, SMEs organize content, and candidates experience respectful hiring.
Measurable or observable outcomes	Example: built 3 dashboards, coordinated 40 participants, wrote 12 posts, reduced manual tracking, and presented to a class.
Constraints	Example: no full-time experience yet, still learning SQL, cannot reveal employer data, prefers hybrid roles in Jakarta.
Tone	Example: beginner, clear, useful, modest, not salesy.

Practice Workflow

1. Take a screenshot of your current headline and About opening lines. Save it as **Before**.
2. Choose one primary target role and collect three real job descriptions.
3. Run Careerflow or LinkedIn profile meter to fix missing sections.
4. Run Jobscan or SkillSyncer for keyword alignment against the three job descriptions.
5. Run Resume Worded LinkedIn Review if you want scored written feedback from the LinkedIn profile PDF.
6. Draft 3 headline options. Keep the one that is clear, honest, and searchable.
7. Draft the About opening using the three-sentence structure, then add 3-5 evidence bullets.
8. Paste into LinkedIn. Turn off profile-update broadcasts if you do not want every edit announced to your network.
9. Take a screenshot of the updated version. Save it as **After**.

Headline Builder

Option A: Role-led

[Target role] | [Skill 1], [Skill 2] & [Tool] | [Audience or output]

Option B: Student-led

[Field] Student | Building skills in [Skill/Tool] | Interested in [Target role/industry]

Option C: Evidence-led

[Target role] | Built [project/output] using [tools] | [Industry/audience focus]

Option D: Switcher-led

[Current strength] + [Target role direction] | [Transferable skill] | [Target industry]

About Builder

- Sentence 1 - Identity and direction
I am a [student/graduate/professional] building toward [role/field].
- Sentence 2 - Evidence
Through [project/course/internship/work/volunteer], I have used [tools/skills] to [output or problem solved].
- Sentence 3 - Contribution
I am looking for a [role/opportunity] where I can help [team/audience] with [value].
- Evidence bullets: Add 3-5 bullets with tools, outputs, proof, and learning direction.
- Closing line: Invite a relevant connection, internship, collaboration, or recruiter conversation without sounding desperate.

Practice Examples

These examples are illustrative personas for practice. They are not copied from the public profiles above. They show how different contexts can adapt the same logic.

Context	Data analyst graduate
Before	Fresh Graduate Open to Work
After headline	Junior Data Analyst Excel, SQL & Power BI Turning survey and operations data into clear dashboards
About evidence focus	Economics graduate, class research, dashboard project, and target analyst roles.

Context	Digital marketing intern
Before	Marketing student who loves creativity
After headline	Digital Marketing Intern Content Planning, Canva & Meta Ads Basics SME Campaign Support
About evidence focus	Campaign plan, content calendar, simple analytics, and internship readiness.

Context	HR assistant candidate
Before	HR enthusiast
After headline	HR Assistant Candidate Recruitment Coordination, Interview Scheduling & HR Documentation Psychology Graduate
About evidence focus	Psychology training, admin discipline, candidate care, HR operations.

Other examples of good profiles:

(1) [Noppon Chhim](#)



Create impact with us

Bringing people from across sectors and industries to create positive social impact, through organizing conferences and events.



Noppon Chhim · 3rd

Project & Event Coordinator for NGOs, Gov and Development Partners.

Phnom Penh, Cambodia · [Contact info](#)

1,122 followers · 500+ connections

+ Follow

Message



American University of Phnom Penh

Open to work

Phnom Penh, Cambodia | Hybrid · Remote

[Show details](#)

About

I operate at the intersection of economics, public policy, and institutional design — focused on helping decision-makers translate evidence into scalable systems.

My background includes working in high-stakes, government-adjacent environments, designing multi-stakeholder initiatives, and facilitating strategic decision rooms under pressure.

I am building deep technical fluency in economic analysis and policy evaluation to design systems that shape long-term economic and social outcomes.



Why it's good

The example creates a coherent professional story rather than listing broad traits.

1. Sentence 1 - Identity and direction: It quickly states who he is now and the role or field he is building toward, so the reader can understand his professional direction.
2. Sentence 2 - Evidence: It names relevant experience and connects specific tools or skills to an output. This makes the profile more credible because the claims are supported by work he can explain.
3. Sentence 3 - Contribution: It identifies the opportunity he is seeking and the value he can offer a team, giving the profile a clear next step.
4. Overall: The identity, evidence, and intended contribution reinforce one another. The language is specific enough to be searchable while remaining honest about an early-career level.

Paste Into LinkedIn: Practical Steps

1. On LinkedIn, open your profile and click the pencil icon in the introduction card.
2. Paste the final headline. Check that it is readable on mobile; shorten if the main role disappears.
3. Scroll to About and click edit. Paste the three-sentence opening plus evidence bullets.
4. Add line breaks so the opening does not look like a wall of text.
5. Update Skills so the top skills match your target role and appear in your evidence.
6. Update Open to Work preferences if appropriate. Choose visibility carefully; LinkedIn says recruiter-only visibility cannot guarantee complete privacy from current-company recruiters.
7. Save changes, review the public profile view, and take an after screenshot.

References

S1. LinkedIn Help - Use the profile level meter to update your profile.

<https://www.linkedin.com/help/linkedin/answer/a594698/viewing-your-profile-strength-meter?lang=en> Used for profile completeness and discoverability sections.

S2. LinkedIn Help - Let recruiters know you are Open to Work.

<https://www.linkedin.com/help/linkedin/answer/a507508/making-your-profile-visible-or-hidden-from-recruiters?lang=en> Used for Open to Work visibility and privacy caution.

S3. LinkedIn Help - Recruiter and Recruiter Lite search filters and definitions.

<https://www.linkedin.com/help/linkedin/answer/a414428/search-in-recruiter?lang=en> Used for recruiter search filter explanation.

S4. Careerflow - LinkedIn Optimizer. <https://www.careerflow.ai/linkedin-optimizer> Used for Careerflow feature walkthrough.

S5. Jobscan - LinkedIn Optimization Tool.

<https://www.jobscan.co/linkedin-optimization> Used for Jobscan workflow and job-description comparison.

S6. Rezi - LinkedIn Resume Builder. <https://www.rezi.ai/linkedin-resume-builder> Used for Rezi LinkedIn import workflow.

Prepared for learning use. Verify live tool interfaces and pricing before delivery because AI tool features change frequently.

